PROPERTY FINDER · PRODUCT BUILDER CHALLENGE

# Trust Assistant: a short list you can believe

Prototype ↗ Repo ↗ Audit (Excel) ↗ Rules ↗ Probable bug ↗

## Persona

**Divyanshi**, short-term renter
India → Dubai, first time

*"Show me a studio I'd actually like, at the price I'll really pay."*

**Needs**

- Studio with a real kitchen; monthly terms
- All-in ≤ AED 7,500/mo, approved by her company
- Safe building, metro or easy cabs
- Finalise from India, on her phone

**Frustrations**

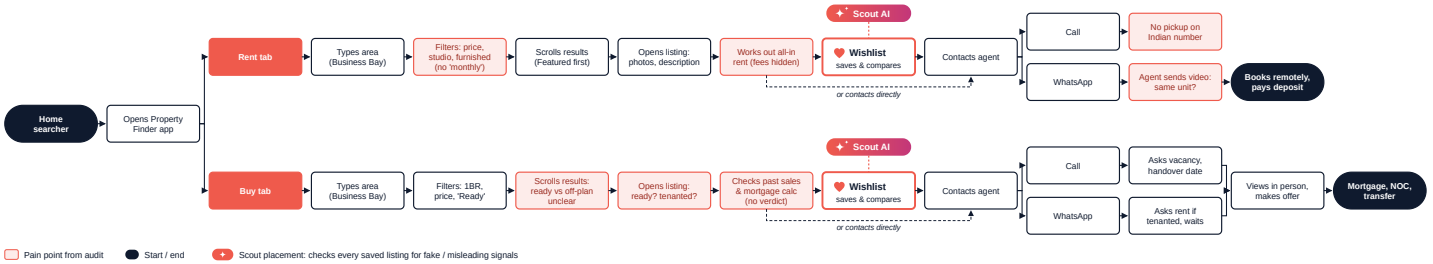
- Hidden fees broke an approved budget
- Bait photos; a different unit on WhatsApp
- Re-explains needs; agents ignore Indian numbers
- Only ~10 of 30 WhatsApps got a reply (my past search)
- Loses track across ~10 WhatsApp chats

## Stakeholders

1. **Searcher** — Renter or buyer seeking a real home
2. **Agent / Agency** — Posts listings, earns from leads
3. **Property Owner** — Landlord or seller wanting a fair price
4. **Property Finder** — Balances agent revenue with searcher trust
5. **Holiday-Home Operators** — Short-stay units with hotel-style fees
6. **Developers** — Sell off-plan using renders and "from" prices

** I studied the renter's flow in depth; the buyer's flow only at a bird's-eye level, within this assignment's scope.*

## User journey




## The problem behind the problem

**On the surface:** some listings are fake. **Underneath:** from the page she can't tell which listings are real, available and within budget. So she messages everyone, waits, and gives up; honest listings get buried under bait; and PF never learns which listings misled her, because the truth comes out later on WhatsApp.
**Audit, 32 live studios (Excel · repo):** only 2/30 raise no warning sign · 0/30 let you work out the all-in price · 16/30 listed 90+ days ago · only 12/32 were worth an inquiry.

## Rules · full set ↗

Each warning sign lowers trust. Scout sorts saved homes into **Looks genuine** · **Needs checking** · **Likely misleading**, and always says why.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| R1 | No permit, or fake licence | R2 | "Studio" is really a hotel room |
| R3 | Two or more warning signs | R4 | Listed 90+ days: still free? |
| R5 | Price ±20% vs area median | R6 | Same unit, 2 agents, same price |
| R7 | Photos or size don't match | R8 | Hidden fees or conditional price |
| R9 | Building or location unclear | R10 | Buyer: handover, tenancy unclear |

**Where rules break:** each rule in RULES.md lists a real case where it's wrong, e.g. R6 thinks #16/#17 are one unit; they're on different floors. Tested on my 32 calls: 14/32 → 31/32.

## Where it lives

In the **Wishlist**, on web and app: the ♥ is the trigger. Scout checks every saved home ("Scout checked your 32 saved homes: 8 look misleading"); each card shows **Looks genuine**, **Needs checking** or **Likely misleading** with a one-line reason. "Ask Scout to verify" drafts one message per agent; nothing is sent until she taps Send. Not on search results (I couldn't reach Scout): verdicts stay private, no public badge.

## Why use it, and when not

**Use it to find out:** which listings are real, which agents are likely to reply, which listings are misleading, and which really fit the budget once the fees hidden in the description are added. **Don't:** when you already trust the agent, for viewings, negotiation or signing (it hands over to a human), or for legal or mortgage decisions.

## Agents and PF revenue (a suggestion)

No data yet on the revenue impact, so this is the trade-off if PF ships it.
**Pros:** honest agents get serious leads and credit for stating fees; bait listings lose leads; verdicts stay private, so no public label hits paying agents; a trust edge over Bayut's TruCheck; PF learns which listings mislead. **Cons:** fewer raw leads at first, while PF earns per listing and lead; false flags can hurt honest agents (holiday homes look stale); agent pushback.

## Metrics it moves

**Portal metrics:** searcher-to-lead rate, agent reply rate, lead-to-viewing/deal rate, returning searchers, agent spend.
**What Scout should move, from the 32-listing audit:** fewer messages wasted on poor listings (only 12/32 were worth one), a higher agent reply rate (~10/30 in my search), and a faster route to a trusted short list. The size of each move needs the 1% test.

**One number that proves it:** the **confirmed-match rate**. Of the homes Scout marks Looks genuine, how many does the agent confirm are real, still free and at the price Scout showed? **Test:** switch Scout on for 1% of rent searchers in Business Bay and Marina for 4 weeks; the other 99% use PF as today. Compare Scout's homes with the homes the 99% message. **Proves me wrong:** Scout's homes are confirmed less than 5 points more often, or viewings per searcher don't go up.

## What I could not build (priority order)

| Feature | Why it's needed | Why I couldn't add it |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Real agent replies** | Real replies and reply rates (simulated / sample in the UI) | No WhatsApp or PF inbox integration; no reply data |
| **2. Buyer-side prototype** | The assistant must work for buyers too | Time; buyer research was bird's-eye only (8 listings, no interviews) |
| **3. Pages for all listings** | Only #11 and #16 open as full listing pages | Short on time |
| **4. Live permit and licence check** | R1: proves who the advertiser is | No DLD Trakheesi / DTCM data access |
| **5. Live listing feed** | Rules must run on every listing, not 32 | No PF listings API; audit was by hand |
| **6. Photo matching across listings** | R7: catches recycled bait photo sets | Needs PF's image store plus engineering |
| **7. DLD transaction prices** | R5: fair price per building, esp. for buyers | No DLD feed; used listing medians instead |
| **8. Outcome feedback loop** | Contradicted listings reported to PF moderation | Needs PF backend and a moderation process |
| **9. LLM reading of descriptions** | Extracts fees and terms from free text | No API key; prototype uses fixed rules |